Atlanta Botanical Garden - Expansion

Setsugekka Camellia

Camellia sasanqua 'Setsugekka'

Family: Not stated Also known as: —

GARDENS Shuttle Path: 9 **TOTAL 9**



Summer / form
Library candidate

Not available

Fall color
Not available



Flower
Library candidate

Not available

Leaf close-up
Not available

QUICK FACTS & PLANTING

Type: Tree
Evergreen/Deciduous: Evergreen
Mature size: 8–12 ft. Confirmed by multiple sources (Gardenia, plant lust, Twin Branch, Rainy Side). × 6–10 ft. Confirmed range.
Hardiness / Zone 8a: Suitable for Zone 8a. Hardy Zones 7–9. Sasanqua camellias perform well in Atlanta with afternoon shade and acidic, well-drained soil.
Fall-to-winter bloomer. Restart pass (2026-10-13): NC State confirms 6–14 ft, full sun to partial shade, well-drained soils, more resistant to Phytophthora than C. japonica, blooms over 4–6 weeks. [https://plants.ces.ncsu.edu/plants/camellia-sasanqua/]
Sun: Full sun to part shade. Morning sun / afternoon shade preferred. More sun-tolerant than C. japonica.
Water: Medium. Prefers moist, well-drained soil. Drought tolerant once established.
Soil: Well-drained, acidic, humus-rich. Prefers slightly acidic.
Growth rate: Not stated
Not stated
Planting:
Siting: Plant high (crown above soil line) in acidic, well-drained, humus-rich soil. Afternoon shade beneficial. Water regularly until established. Mulch to keep roots cool. Prune lightly after flowering if needed for shape or hedge. Suitable as specimen, hedge, or espalier.
Soil prep: Well-drained, acidic, humus-rich. Prefers slightly acidic.
Depth/spacing: Not stated
Season: Not stated
Establishment: Not stated

ORIGIN, CHARACTERISTICS & HEALTH

Origin / native: Camellia sasanqua cultivar. Produced by Jisuke Minagawa in Japan. Synonyms include 'Fluted White', 'Wavy White', 'Elegant Friends', 'Moon and Flowers'.
Form / habit: Evergreen shrub or small tree. Upright to spreading, dense. Can be trained as hedge, espalier, or specimen.
Foliage: None (evergreen).
Flowers / fruit: Not stated
Bark / stem: Not stated in detail.
Not stated
Health:
Health notes: Typical camellia issues possible (scale, petal blight, root rot in poor drainage). No serious problems uniquely stated for this cultivar. Low maintenance when sited correctly. **Open:** Specific Zone 8a incidence is thin.
Not stated
Additional:
- Large semi-double white flowers with ruffled petals and golden stamens. - Blooms fall to mid-winter. - Glossy dark green evergreen foliage. - Vigorous upright habit. - Good for hedging or screening.